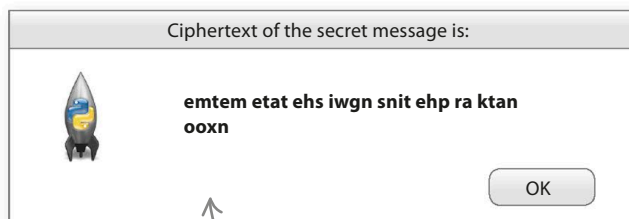


13 Run encryption

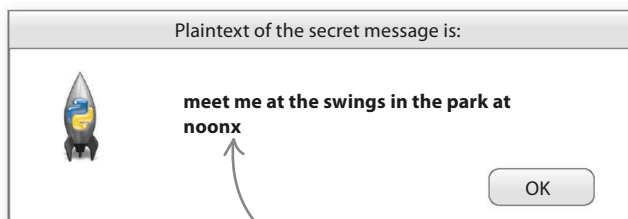
Test your program. Choose “encrypt” in the task window. When the message window pops up, enter the sort of message a spy might want to keep secret. Try: “meet me at the swings in the park at noon”!

14 Run decryption

If you select the encrypted text and copy it, you can choose the “decrypt” option next time round the loop. In the message window, paste the encrypted message and click OK. You’ll then see the original message again.



The program tells you when the message is in ciphertext.



Your fellow agent will know that the extra x needs to be ignored.

15 Decrypt this!

Your cipher program should now be working. To make sure, try decrypting the text shown here. You can now share your Python code with a friend and start sending secret messages!

ewlld no eoy uahevd ceyrtpdet ih sesrctem seaseg

oy uac nsu eelom nujci erom li ksai vnsibieli kn

Hacks and tweaks

Here are some ideas to make your secret messages even more difficult to read if they’re intercepted by an enemy agent – such as a nosy brother or sister!

▷ Remove the spaces

One way to make your cipher more secure is to remove the spaces and any punctuation characters, such as full stops and commas. To do this, type your message without spaces and punctuation. Just make sure the friend you’re swapping messages with knows that this is the plan.

